

Xiaochuan Li

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Computational cognitive science and language model interpretability. Current focus: epistemic modality.

EDUCATION

University of Technology Nuremberg

Nuremberg, Germany

M.Sc. Human and Artificial Intelligence

Oct. 2025 – exp. 2027

Selected coursework: Cognitive Psychology; Foundations in Psychology & Empirical Study Design; Deep Learning; Interpretability for Natural Language Processing.

University of Marburg

Marburg, Germany

Preparatory studies: German for graduate study

2024 – 2025

Shenzhen University

Shenzhen, China

B.A. Philosophy

2020 – 2024

Selected coursework: Logic; Mathematical Logic; Analytic Philosophy; Psychology of Reading; Cognition and Learning Disabilities.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Epistemic modality in people and language models

2026 –

Current focus · how modal expressions are understood and used, by people and by language models

FORMAL ANALYSIS

Three Ways of Leaving *p* Unsettled: compares *might p*, *might p or might not p* and *I don't know whether p* by the replies each licenses. *In development.*

HUMAN STUDY

M.Sc. thesis: modal language in preschool children, alongside a possibilities study at MPI CBS Leipzig; supervised by C. Grosse Wiesmann (UTN), with T. Hopf (MPI CBS). *In planning.*

COMPUTATIONAL MODEL

Modal choice: three competing accounts of the choice between *must* and *might*, to be fitted to published human data. *In development.*

Moral framing and dilemma choices in language models

2026–27

Year-long project course · with M. Roth (UTN) and S. Ostermann (DFKI)

Designed and ran the controlled experiments and causal interventions for the utilitarian-framing branch; manuscript in preparation.

Typicality in referent choice: what the description leaves open

2026

Independent theoretical study

Distinguishes three conditions for typicality in referent choice and the limits of what a forced-choice task can establish.

Li, X. (2026). Working paper. lingbuzz/010343 · [doi:10.5281/zenodo.22855036](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22855036)

Cross-lingual ProtoBias

Summer 2026

Single-author course project

Evaluation of two VLM families across seven prompt languages, about 12,600 judgments.

[report](#) · [code](#)

Street-view country classification

Summer 2026

Team course project, Deep Learning

My part: CNN training, ablations, and performance analysis.

Fact-checking after ChatGPT exposure

Winter 2025–26

Course study, Foundations in Psychology and Empirical Study Design

Between-subjects experiment (N = 49, 47 analysed), group-designed and adopted for the class-wide study; my part: data analysis.

Leibniz’s logical system and characteristica universalis

2024

Undergraduate thesis · Shenzhen University · supervisor: Zang Yong

Analysed Leibniz’s metaphysics, logic and proposal for a universal symbolic language.

Learning difficulties in primary-school children

Sep.–Dec. 2021

Invited research project · Shenzhen Learning Disorders Association and Yucai No. 2 Primary School

Prepared character-reading materials and administered timed tests; analysed response data to identify learning difficulties and helped design teaching items and individual learning plans.

EMPLOYMENT

University of Technology Nuremberg

Nuremberg, Germany

IT Service Desk (part-time)

Apr. 2026 – present

Designed and delivered IT onboarding training for incoming students, with follow-up one-to-one support; also system installation, service reporting, and inventory.

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Programming	Python (PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, pandas, scikit-learn), Git, LaTeX
Methods	PsychoPy/Pavlovia, JASP; probing, activation patching, steering (working proficiency)
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), German (C1), English (C1), Japanese (learning)